Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Kenya Has a New Law-Backed Plan to Force Public Offices to Release Records. Will It Work?** — Dawan Africa, 13 October 2026 KENYA

  An explainer on Kenya's newly gazetted Access to Information Policy asks whether it will change practice: citizens already hold a right to request records, it notes, but often do not get them. *Also under Open data and Data protection.*

- **Kenya Allocates KSh 13 Billion to Expand Fibre Network by 27,000 Kilometres** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya will put KSh 13 billion into extending its national fibre backbone and cross-border links by at least 27,000 km, the ICT principal secretary told a pre-bid session. Gaps are to be allocated by reverse auction to draw matching private capital. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **Government directs AI policy for civil servants as ICT Summit opens in Ongwediva** — Namibia Economist, 13 October 2026 NAMIBIA

  Namibia's Cabinet has directed the Office of the Prime Minister and the ICT ministry to develop an internal policy on civil servants' use of artificial intelligence, the ICT minister announced at the National ICT Summit. No timeline or draft was given. *Also under AI.*

- **Gender-Inclusive AI Governance: Policy Options and Institutional Pathways for African Governments** — African Center for Economic Transformation, 13 October 2026 GHANA KENYA MAURITIUS AFRICA

  A think-tank paper sets out policy options for African governments to build gender inclusion into artificial intelligence governance, arguing that the first national strategies arrive while governments still hold bargaining power over how the technology enters their economies. *Also under AI and Digital divides.*

- **Cybersécurité : la Côte d'Ivoire organise sa première simulation nationale de crise cyber - Abidjan.net News** — Abidjan.net, 13 October 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Côte d'Ivoire's information-systems security agency will run a first national cyber-crisis simulation in Abidjan on 28 and 29 October 2026. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **CS Kabogo gazettes new policy to boost public access to government information** — People Daily, 13 October 2026 KENYA

Kenya's ICT Cabinet Secretary gazetted the Access to Information Policy, 2026 on 9 October. It requires public offices to disclose key records proactively, answer requests within set timelines and give written reasons for refusals. *Also under Open data.*

Legislation and regulation

- **ICASA strives for balance in rapidly-changing digital economy** — ITWeb South Africa, 13 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's communications regulator is widening its approach to take in satellite services, data centres, cloud computing and artificial intelligence, its chairperson said. It is weighing conventional licensing against lighter oversight and regulatory sandboxes. *Also under Connectivity and Data Storage.*

Data protection

- **L'ANSD envisage de faciliter l'accès à distance aux données anonymisées (DG)** — Agence de Presse Sénégalaise, 13 October 2026 SENEGAL

  Senegal's statistics agency is working towards remote access for authorised researchers to the anonymised detailed data now consulted on site in its data-access centres. Its director-general named personal-data protection, access security and conditions of use as the questions to settle. *Also under National statistics.*

- **GID denies losing access to National ID card data** — Gambiana, 13 October 2026 GAMBIA

  The Gambia Immigration Department denied losing access to national identity card data, saying the servers used under the former contract remain in the country. It attributed the reports to a misunderstanding of an officer's court testimony. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS.*

- **Gabon : La frontière entre dans l'ère des données** — InfosGabon, 13 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's transport minister visited a United States operator's installations at Libreville airport to speed the commissioning of a passenger-data screening system, insisting that trained national staff run it. No go-live date or cost was given. *Also under Data Exchange.*

- **Egypt PDPL Compliance Checklist: What to Do Before the October 31, 2026 Deadline** — Shura Law Firm, 13 October 2026 EGYPT

  A law firm's checklist notes that the one-year transition under the executive regulations of Egypt's Personal Data Protection Law ends on 31 October 2026, and that the Personal Data Protection Centre opened its portal for licence and permit applications in early October.

- **DPC strengthens enforcement after registering 2,575 data controllers | Ghana News Agency** — Ghana News Agency, 13 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's Data Protection Commission said it had registered 2,575 data controllers in 2026, more than in any previous year, and was adding spot checks, inspections and complaint investigations.

- **ASSEMBLÉE NATIONALE : QUATRE TEXTES GOUVERNEMENTAUX ET CINQ PROPOSITIONS D'ENQUÊTE À L'OUVERTURE DE LA SESSION ORDINAIRE 2026-2027** — Radiodiffusion Télévision Sénégalaise, 13 October 2026 SENEGAL

  Majority deputies in Senegal's National Assembly filed a proposal for a commission of inquiry into the health cooperation agreement with the United States, in particular what it means for Senegalese personal data. The Assembly's Bureau will rule on whether it is admissible. *Also under US / hyperscaler activities and Connectivity.*

- **Kenya Has a New Law-Backed Plan to Force Public Offices to Release Records. Will It Work?** — Dawan Africa, 13 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Regional collaboration

- **Les travaux du forum sur la gouvernance de l'Internet en Afrique centrale lancés à N'Djamena - Tchadinfos** — Tchadinfos, 13 October 2026 CHAD CENTRAL AFRICA

  Chad's digital ministry and its partners opened the Central Africa Internet Governance Forum in N'Djamena on 13 October 2026. *Also under AI.*

- **Emerging Technologies: Can Africa's Digital Infrastructure Keep Up?** — Science Africa, 13 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE AFRICA

  In an interview, a senior engineer at Sierra Leone's telecommunications regulator says gaps in connectivity, technical skills and cross-border integration stand between African countries and artificial intelligence and cloud services, and argues for sustained investment in infrastructure, skills and regulation. *Also under Connectivity and Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **ATDI, MJCR, DNIC, SENAMI e INATRO preparam implementação da Identidade Digital em Moçambique** — MozNews, 13 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Mozambique's digital agency is leading a 14-member technical mission to Ethiopia to prepare a national digital identity, with staff from the justice ministry, civil identification, the migration service and the road-transport institute. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Training and skills.*

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Sudanese Banks with Foreign Shareholdings: Between the Need for Openness and Legitimate Concerns** — Sudan Horizon, 13 October 2026 SUDAN

  A Sudanese report examines foreign shareholdings in the country's 38 banks, a question raised when the government cut relations with the United Arab Emirates in May 2025 while Emirati investors held more than 40% of the bank behind the most used banking app. It weighs the need for outside capital against influence over the post-war banking sector. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

Finance

New investments

- **[K-ODA 현장]④ '아프리카 IT 심장부'로…한국형 마이스터고 품은 르완다** — Yonhap News Agency, 13 October 2026 RWANDA

  A South Korean news agency reports from the Rwanda Coding Academy, a secondary school modelled on Korean vocational schools and supported by Korea's aid agency with about 10.9 billion won. *Also under Training and skills.*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Sud-Kivu : la société civile exige la réouverture des réseaux de télécommunications coupés depuis 3 mois** — CongoRassure, 13 October 2026 DRC

Civil society in Fizi territory and Baraka, South Kivu, published a memorandum to the President demanding the reopening of telecommunications networks it says have been cut since 3 July 2026. It alleges that soldiers seized satellite kits and phones and that local authorities resold satellite Wi-Fi, and announces a sit-in from 19 October. *Also under Access to services.*

- **Nigerians used 90% of 2025's internet data volume in eight months** — TechCabal, 13 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigerians used 11.94 million terabytes of internet data in January to August 2026, about 90% of the whole of 2025, on the regulator's statistics. August alone took 1.76 million terabytes, with about 800,000 new internet subscriptions. *Also under National statistics.*

- **MTN SA trials Africa's first 5G-U6GHz network** — ITWeb Africa, 13 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  MTN South Africa said it had completed a 5G-Advanced trial in the upper 6GHz band at its headquarters, under a temporary licence, reaching peak downloads of 10.35 gigabits a second. The regulator's 2026 frequency plan allocates the band to mobile, but it is not yet licensed commercially.

- **Hamzat tasks govt, businesses on technology-driven jobs, inclusive growth** — Realnews Magazine, 13 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Lagos State's deputy governor said more than 6.4 million residents have enrolled in the state's resident identity system. He put state fibre at about 3,000 km, with a further US$22 million invested towards a 6,000 km network. *Also under Digitalisation of sub-national government and Digital Identity and CRVS.*

- **DIGISEN : "La couverture réseau n'est pas la connectivité", ce que révèle une étude** — Seneweb, 13 October 2026 SENEGAL

  A four-year research project in Saint-Louis and Ziguinchor, Senegal, collected more than 100,000 connectivity measurements and concluded that network coverage is not the same as connectivity: cost, place, time of day and gender shape the service people actually get. *Also under Digital divides.*

- **Connectivité : la RDC explore des solutions abordables pour étendre le réseau** — Agence Ecofin, 13 October 2026 DRC

  DR Congo's posts and telecommunications ministry is promoting solar-powered microsites to extend mobile coverage to rural and peri-urban areas, presented to the universal service fund and four operators. Fifty pilot sites are planned, each said to cost a quarter of a conventional mast. *Also under Digital divides.*

- **Kenya Allocates KSh 13 Billion to Expand Fibre Network by 27,000 Kilometres** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **ICASA strives for balance in rapidly-changing digital economy** — ITWeb South Africa, 13 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **Emerging Technologies: Can Africa's Digital Infrastructure Keep Up?** — Science Africa, 13 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **ASSEMBLÉE NATIONALE : QUATRE TEXTES GOUVERNEMENTAUX ET CINQ PROPOSITIONS D'ENQUÊTE À L'OUVERTURE DE LA SESSION ORDINAIRE 2026-2027** — Radiodiffusion Télévision Sénégalaise, 13 October 2026 SENEGAL

  Summarised under Data protection.

Data Storage

- **Cassava's Pemhiwa Says Africa Must Keep Its Data at Home** — Business Explainer, 13 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA AFRICA

  The chief executive of Cassava Technologies said Africa risks repeating its history of exporting raw commodities unless it builds its own computing capacity for artificial intelligence and keeps its data on the continent. *Also under AI and Digital sovereignty.*

- **ICASA strives for balance in rapidly-changing digital economy** — ITWeb South Africa, 13 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Technical Capacity

- **Microsoft to shut Nairobi engineering centre, putting hundreds of jobs at risk** — TechCabal, 13 October 2026 KENYA

  Microsoft is winding down its Africa Development Centre in Nairobi, staff were told on 12 October, putting nearly 400 jobs at risk with fewer than 10 expected to remain. The company confirmed only proposed changes to its engineering operations; Kenya's ICT Cabinet Secretary, briefed the same day, agreed a joint action plan with it. *Also under ICT Industry.*

Cybersecurity

- **Gov't committed to expanding digital infrastructure and inclusion – Sam George | Ghana News Agency** — Ghana News Agency, 13 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's communications minister presented 2,000 more laptops to a university for the One Million Coders Programme, where 195 of 1,447 enrolled students had completed the course. He said the ministry was working to open regional offices of the Cyber Security Authority. *Also under Training and skills and Access to services.*

- **Cybersécurité : la Côte d'Ivoire organise sa première simulation nationale de crise cyber - Abidjan.net News** — Abidjan.net, 13 October 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

DPI

Data Exchange

- **Gvt Moves to Create National Database for Small Businesses** — 263Chat, 13 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's small-enterprise development corporation said a national database of micro, small and medium enterprises has reached minimum-viable-product stage, with an online registration portal in development. Talks are under way to link it to the revenue authority and the procurement regulator. *Also under Registries.*

- **Government connects 222 public health facilities to digital records system** — The Citizen (Tanzania), 13 October 2026 TANZANIA

Tanzania's health ministry said 222 public health facilities are connected to an integrated electronic medical records system introduced in October 2025. It named unreliable connectivity, power, equipment shortages and incomplete interoperability as obstacles to covering the country. *Also under Sectoral management information systems*.

- **Electronic traffic system being finalised** — Zimbabwe Situation, 13 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's police said logistics for an Electronic Traffic Management System were being finalised. The system is linked to the vehicle and civil registries to identify offenders and issue penalties electronically. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and AI*.

- **Gabon : La frontière entre dans l'ère des données** — InfosGabon, 13 October 2026 GABON

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Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Hamzat tasks govt, businesses on technology-driven jobs, inclusive growth** — Realnews Magazine, 13 October 2026 NIGERIA

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- **ATDI, MJCR, DNIC, SENAMI e INATRO preparam implementação da Identidade Digital em Moçambique** — MozNews, 13 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Bede Sudan Launches BBAN Service to Strengthen Banking Integration and Expand Digital Transaction** — Sudan Horizon, 13 October 2026 SUDAN

  Bede Sudan, a mobile operator's fintech arm, launched a bank account number service that links its digital wallet to the banking system, with a commercial bank and central bank approval. Wallet users can send and receive funds across all Sudanese banks. *Also under Access to services*.

- **Sudanese Banks with Foreign Shareholdings: Between the Need for Openness and Legitimate Concerns** — Sudan Horizon, 13 October 2026 SUDAN

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

- **Emerging Technologies: Can Africa's Digital Infrastructure Keep Up?** — Science Africa, 13 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Registries

- **Gvt Moves to Create National Database for Small Businesses** — 263Chat, 13 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

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Sectoral management information systems

- **Ministère de la Fonction Publique et du Renforcement des Capacités - Accélération des préparatifs de mise en œuvre du Système Intégré de Gestion des Ressources Humaines - Ministère de la Fonction Publique et du Renforcement des Capacités** — Ministère de la Fonction Publique et du Renforcement des Capacités (Gabon), 13 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's civil-service ministry reviewed technical preparations for an integrated human resources management system and named the procurement tender as the next step. The platform, under a World Bank-supported project, is to hold one register of state employees linked to payroll, budget and national identification. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Government connects 222 public health facilities to digital records system** — The Citizen (Tanzania), 13 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **How ignored warnings, missing feasibility studies plagued Uganda's digital plates project** — Daily Monitor (Uganda), 13 October 2026 UGANDA

  A former works minister told a Ugandan parliamentary committee that the digital number plate rollout went ahead without a preliminary feasibility study, and a former internal affairs minister said early warnings were ignored. The contractor defended plate fees paid to it rather than into the Consolidated Fund.

- **Digitisation raises C/River revenue by N46bn in 6 months** — Trust Radio, 13 October 2026 NIGERIA

  The head of a technology firm said digitising government services had raised Cross River State's internally generated revenue by N46 billion in under a year. The figure is the firm's own. *Also under Digitalisation of sub-national government*.

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Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

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Technology

AI

- **中华人民共和国和博茨瓦纳共和国关于建立全面战略合作伙伴关系的联合声明** — Embassy of the People's Republic of China in Tanzania (republishing the China-Botswana joint statement), 13 October 2026 BOTSWANA

  China and Botswana raised relations to a comprehensive strategic partnership in a joint statement issued during President Duma Boko's state visit. It affirms digital sovereignty and each state's right to choose its own path on artificial intelligence; Botswana joins China's digital economy trade-cooperation initiative and will consider joining the World AI Cooperation Organization. *Also under China activities and Digital sovereignty.*

- **Kenya Launches KSG Digital Institute as 1,239 Public Officers Graduate in AI Training** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026 KENYA

  The Kenya School of Government launched an eLearning and Information Technology Institute as 1,239 public officers graduated from a UNESCO-Oxford programme on artificial intelligence and digital transformation in government. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Les travaux du forum sur la gouvernance de l'Internet en Afrique centrale lancés à N'Djamena - Tchadinfos** — Tchadinfos, 13 October 2026 CHAD CENTRAL AFRICA

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- **Cassava's Pemhiwa Says Africa Must Keep Its Data at Home** — Business Explainer, 13 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA AFRICA

  Summarised under Data Storage.

ICT Industry

- **Microsoft's Nairobi Development Centre Faces Possible Closure** — Kenyans.co.ke, 13 October 2026 KENYA

  Microsoft plans to close the engineering department of its Africa Development Centre in Nairobi after more than seven years, a Kenyan outlet reports. Between 400 and 500 employees could be affected. *Also under US / hyperscaler activities.*

- **Microsoft to shut Nairobi engineering centre, putting hundreds of jobs at risk** — TechCabal, 13 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Technical Capacity.

Capacity

Literacy

- **Kenya Gets World Bank Funding to Expand Digital Literacy in Schools** — Kenyans.co.ke, 13 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's ICT Authority invited consulting firms to express interest in integrating digital literacy into the competency-based school curriculum through gender-inclusive strategies, under a World Bank-funded digital economy project. Firms must show experience in developing artificial intelligence curricula.

Training and skills

- **Kenya Commissions Jitume ICT Hub in Uasin Gishu as Digital Network Reaches 391 Sites** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya commissioned a Jitume ICT hub at a technical training campus in Uasin Gishu, taking the national network to 391 equipped sites and 23,387 devices. Of 253 technical and vocational institutions, 186 have the equipment and 67 still wait. *Also under Access to services.*

- **Ghana Reviews One Million Coders Programme After Beneficiaries Raise Training Challenges** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's communications ministry is addressing training and infrastructure problems in the One Million Coders Programme after beneficiaries raised them in a monitoring exercise. *Also under Access to services.*

- **Kenya Launches KSG Digital Institute as 1,239 Public Officers Graduate in AI Training** — Tech Africa News, 13 October 2026 KENYA

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Inclusion

Access to services

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Digital divides

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Data

National statistics

- **Sierra Leone counts down to first fully digital census** — The Sierra Leone Telegraph, 13 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Sierra Leone opened the 50-day countdown to its 2026 Population and Housing Census, its first fully digital enumeration. Census Night is 1 December and nationwide enumeration starts the next day.

- **Nigerians used 90% of 2025's internet data volume in eight months** — TechCabal, 13 October 2026 NIGERIA

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- **L'ANSD envisage de faciliter l'accès à distance aux données anonymisées (DG)** — Agence de Presse Sénégalaise, 13 October 2026 SENEGAL

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Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

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China activities

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Digital sovereignty

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This bulletin is produced automatically at the end of each data collection sweep but only includes items published on the day cited in the edition, and the previous day. Items published in the last month can be found on the country pages. The links to all items stored in the corpus can be found in the catalogue.

Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country pages and the monthly reports.